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Beyond Anthropocentric Boundaries, Childling as an Embodied Kind of Praxis: A Conversation with Jayne Osgood and Sid Mohandas

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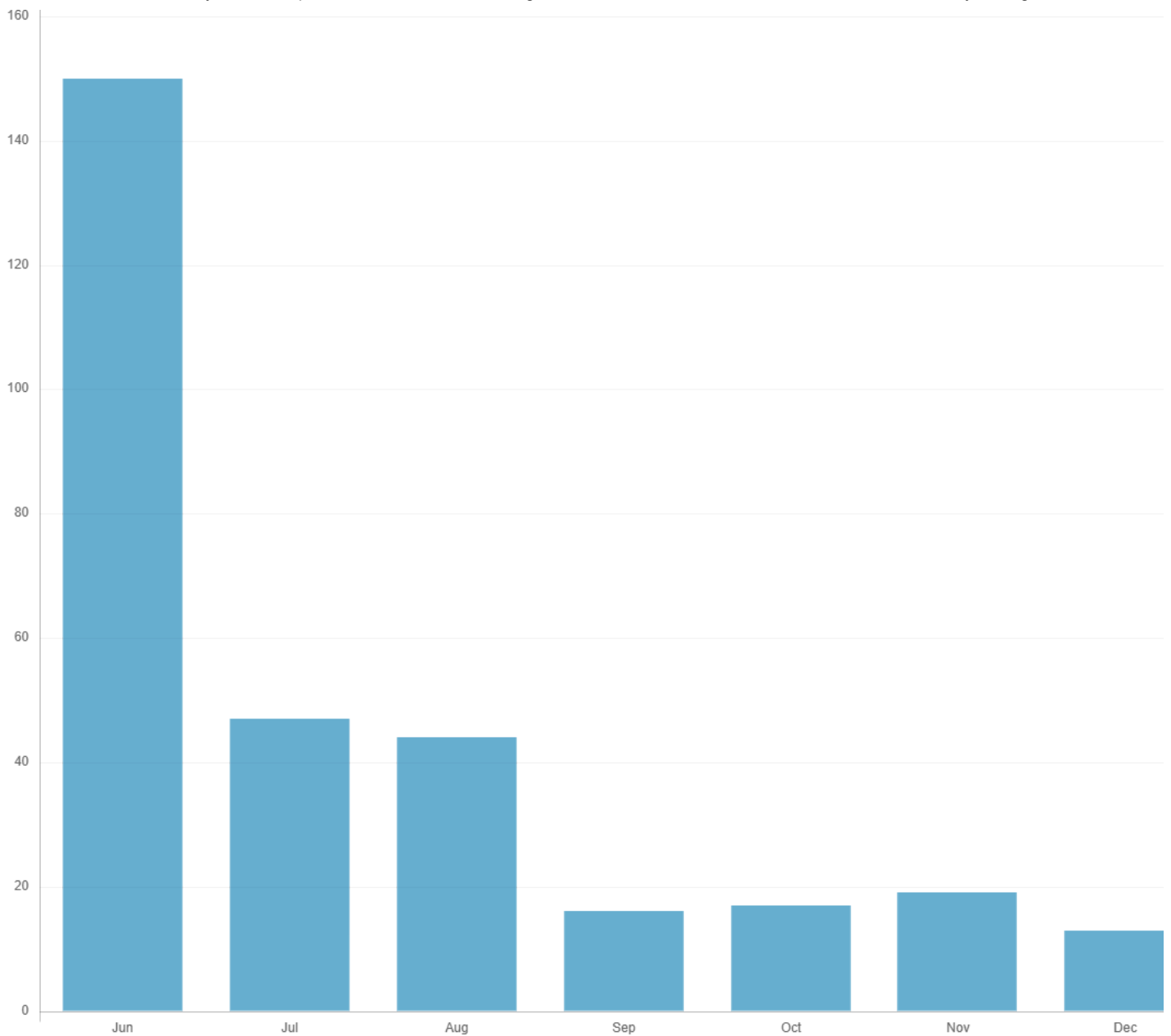
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Abstract

This intra-view explores the idea of “childling” as an embodied, relational kind of praxis that challenges colonial and anthropocentric frameworks in education. The authors discuss how childling disrupts linear notions of time, hierarchies of knowledge, and conventional adult-child binaries by focusing on sensibilities and relationalities. Grounded in critical posthumanist theories and thinking with Indigenous perspectives, childling invites disruption, care, re-membling, and re-turning to land and more-than-human relations, fostering experiential and inclusive ways of being, doing and knowing. The conversation highlights how embracing childling can unsettle colonial influences, and open new spaces for learning across early childhood to higher education contexts.

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Author Biographies

Jayne Osgood, Middlesex University

Dr. Jayne Osgood is Professor of Childhood Studies at the Centre for Education Research and Scholarship, Middlesex University (London, UK). Her work addresses issues of worldly justice through critical engagement with policy, curricular frameworks, and pedagogical approaches in Early Childhood Education and Care. She is committed to extending understandings of the workforce, families, gender and sexualities, “child,” and “childhood” in early years contexts through creative, affective methodologies. She has published extensively within the postmodernist paradigm. She is also Book Series Editor for both Bloomsbury (*Feminist Thought in Childhood Research*; and *Postdevelopmental Approaches to Childhood*) and Springer (*Keythinkers in Education*).

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Dr. Sid Mohandas is a Montessori practitioner and childhood studies scholar, whose research employs feminist, decolonial, anticolonial and more-than-human approaches. Sid has published extensively in peer-reviewed journals and edited book collections. They are the author of the forthcoming book *Re-imagining Gender in the Early Childhood Workforce: Feminist and More-than-human Perspectives* with the Bloomsbury Academic. Sid is currently the co-editor of the Special Issue in *British Education Research Journal* titled “The state of gender(s), young people and education: inequities, inter/intrasexuality and inclusivity”. Sid also serves as an editorial board member for the journal *Reconceptualizing Educational Research Methodology*.

Magali Forte, Université de Sherbrooke

Dr. Magali Forte is Assistant Professor in the Faculty of Education at l’Université de Sherbrooke, in Québec (Canada). She worked for more than 15 years as an elementary and secondary school teacher in Vancouver (BC). Her research focuses on rethinking identities in plurilingual educational contexts involving multimodal literacy practices. She adopts a postqualitative approach while thinking with sociomaterial theories and Indigenous perspectives. She is the co-founder of the Reading/Thinking/Doing (RTD) club which offers to engage in conversations about relational and sociomaterial perspectives. She is also the co-editor of the Intra-view section of *Matter: Journal of New Materialist Research*.

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Dr. Jacky Barreiro holds a PhD in Educational Theory and Practice from Simon Fraser University. Her research interest centres at the intersection of relational and performative theories, the micropolitics of social justice, and education. Jacky is the co-founder of the Reading/Thinking/Doing (RTD) club which holds discussions

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